

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET G — FINAL MASTERY & GRAND CHALLENGE TEST (60 MINS)****CHAPTER 05: STATE AND SOCIETY UP TO 1000 CE**

TIME ALLOWED: 60 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-G-05

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET G - Final Mastery & Grand Challenge Test):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Olympiad / NTSE / Advanced Analytical Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed for **Final Curricular Mastery & In-Depth Analytical Rigour**: Target time is **60 Minutes**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

**GRAND CHALLENGE SPECIAL:** This final assessment tests your multi-disciplinary analytical reasoning across historical source criticism, geomorphological dynamics, constitutional jurisprudence, and microeconomic market equilibria!

Q1. In Kautilya's Saptanga Theory of State expounded in the Arthashastra, which of the following represents the correct organic hierarchy of the seven structural limbs of a sovereign state?

- ☐ A Swami (Ruler), Amatya (Ministers), Janapada (Territory & People), Durga (Fortified Capital), Kosha (Treasury), Danda (Armed Forces), and Mitra (Allies) ☐ B Danda, Kosha, Mitra, Swami, Amatya, Janapada, and Durga ☐ C Mitra, Swami, Kosha, Danda, Janapada, Durga, and Amatya ☐ D Janapada, Durga, Swami, Amatya, Kosha, Danda, and Mitra

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Kautilya's Saptanga theory models the state as an organic body with seven essential elements: Swami (head/king), Amatya (eyes/ministers), Janapada (legs/territory), Durga (arms/fort), Kosha (mouth/treasury), Danda (brain/army), and Mitra (ears/allies).

Q2. The Uttaramerur Inscriptions of Chola King Parantaka I (dated 919 and 921 CE) provide unprecedented constitutional details regarding village assemblies. Through which specific democratic mechanism were committee members (Variyars) chosen?

- ☐ A Hereditary succession determined exclusively by royal birth ☐ B Kudavolai — a blind lottery system where eligible candidates' names inscribed on palm-leaf tickets were drawn from an earthen pot by a young child ☐ C Direct open-air hand voting where only wealthiest merchants had voting rights ☐ D Military duel contested in the village temple courtyard

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Kudavolai system was an ancient Chola democratic lottery where palm-leaf ballots of qualified candidates were shuffled in an earthen pot (kuda) and drawn by a child before the assembly.

Q3. According to the Uttaramerur Inscription, which of the following conditions disqualified a citizen from standing for election to the village executive committees (Variyams)?

- ☐ A Failure to submit audit accounts of previous administrative tenure, or committing moral sins such as theft, adultery, or consuming forbidden drink ☐ B Owning more than one-fourth veli of taxable land ☐ C Having mastered one Veda and four Bhashyas ☐ D Being aged between 35 and 70 years

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The inscriptions strictly disqualified anyone who had not submitted financial accounts of past committee service, anyone convicted of major sins (Patakas), or their close agnatic relatives.

Q4. In the administrative hierarchy of the Gupta Empire, administrative divisions were organised in descending order as:

- ☐ A Bhukti (Province under Uparika) -> Vishaya (District under Vishayapati) -> Vithi (Sub-district) -> Grama (Village under Gramika) ☐ B Grama -> Vithi -> Vishaya -> Bhukti ☐ C Vishaya -> Bhukti -> Grama -> Vithi ☐ D Bhukti -> Grama -> Vishaya -> Vithi

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Gupta administrative system divided the empire into Bhuktis (provinces governed by Uparikas), further subdivided into Vishayas (districts headed by Vishayapatis), Vithis, and Gramas.

Q5. Which distinctive feature characterized land grants (Agrahara and Brahmadeya) issued during the Gupta and Post-Gupta periods according to epigraphic copper plate records?

- ☐ A Grantees were forced to serve as frontline infantry soldiers every winter ☐ B Grantees received perpetual tax exemption (Apravesha) and fiscal immunities, along with administrative and judicial rights over local peasants ☐ C Land was confiscated by the crown every three years to prevent accumulation ☐ D Grantees were prohibited from performing any religious rituals

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Agrahara grants transferred royal revenue collection rights, administrative immunity from royal officers (Apraveshyam), and judicial authority over the village to Brahmana scholars or temples in perpetuity.

Q6. In the Sangam Age of Tamilakam, who were the 'Muventar' referenced in Sangam anthologies?

- ☐ A The three crowned monarchical lineages of Southern India: Cheras, Cholas, and Pandyas ☐ B Three elite guilds of Roman wine merchants residing at Muziris ☐ C Three judicial courts established by the Maurya governor in Madurai ☐ D Three groups of wandering Jain monks

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Muventar ('the three crowned kings') refers to the Chera, Chola, and Pandya dynasties who held sway over the ancient Tamil country during the Sangam era.

Q7. What archaeological evidence firmly confirms extensive oceanic maritime trade between Southern India and the Roman Empire during the first two centuries CE?

- ☐ A Discoveries of Roman amphorae, Arretine rouletted pottery, and hoards of gold and silver denarii of Augustus and Tiberius at Arikamedu and Muziris ☐ B Sanskrit rock inscriptions inscribed by Roman Emperor Nero in the Nilgiri hills ☐ C Colosseum gladiatorial arenas excavated in Madurai ☐ D Roman stone aqueducts built across the Kaveri river delta

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Excavations at Arikamedu (Puducherry) and Pattanam (ancient Muziris) yielded Roman Mediterranean amphorae, rouletted ware, Roman glass, and vast hoards of Imperial Roman gold coins (denarii).

Q8. Which royal official was explicitly created by Mauryan Emperor Ashoka in his 5th Major Rock Edict to promote ethical conduct, inter-faith harmony, and social welfare across diverse communities?

- ☐ A Dhamma Mahamattas ☐ B Samaharta ☐ C Sannidhata ☐ D Rajuka

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: In his 5th Major Rock Edict, Ashoka created the special cadre of Dhamma Mahamattas (Ministers of Dhamma) to propagate moral precepts, dispense welfare, and supervise sectarian harmony.

Q9. In the Mauryan administrative machinery described in Megasthenes' Indica, the municipal administration of the capital Pataliputra was managed by:

- ☐ A A single hereditary dictator appointed by Greek ambassadors ☐ B A municipal board of 30 commissioners divided into six specialized committees of five members each ☐ C The guild master of gold jewelers alone ☐ D A lottery of ordinary taxpayers drawn annually

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Megasthenes recorded that Pataliputra was governed by a 30-member municipal commission divided into 6 boards of 5 members each: arts/crafts, foreigners, births/deaths, trade, manufacturing, and sales taxes.

Q10. What was the economic role of 'Shrenis' (merchant and craft guilds) in ancient Indian urban society up to 1000 CE?

- ☐ A They were illegal underground syndicates banned by all ancient monarchies ☐ B They operated as autonomous corporate bodies that fixed prices, maintained quality standards, trained apprentices, issued guild coinage, and functioned as commercial banks receiving interest-bearing endowments ☐ C They were religious monasteries that prohibited commercial trade ☐ D They were foreign merchant companies that paid taxes only to the Roman Senate

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Shrenis exercised corporate self-governance, laid down trade codes (Shreni-dharma recognized by kings), operated apprentice systems, issued seal-tokens, and accepted permanent cash deposits (Akshayanivi).

Q11. The Junagadh Rock Inscription of Western Kshatrapa ruler Rudradaman I (c. 150 CE) is historically extraordinary because:

- ☐ A It records the peaceful construction and subsequent repairs of the Sudarshana Lake reservoir across Maurya (Chandragupta, Ashoka) and Saka rules without levying extra taxes on citizens ☐ B It is the earliest known Tamil Sangam poem carved on granite in Gujarat ☐ C It declares Buddhism as the mandatory state religion of Saurashtra ☐ D It was written in Egyptian hieroglyphs by Roman diplomats

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription (the earliest long, chaste Sanskrit inscription) details how he repaired the breached embankment of Sudarshana Lake out of his own treasury without emergency levies (Vishti or Pranaya).

Q12. What does the Chinese pilgrim Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang) describe regarding the academic admission standards at Nalanda Mahavihara in the 7th century CE?

- ☐ A Admission was open to all students without any interview or qualification ☐ B A learned gatekeeper (Dwarapala) subjected applicants to severe philosophical examinations at the entrance, rejecting 70% to 80% of candidates ☐ C Only royal princes from Magadha were allowed to enroll ☐ D Tuition fees were paid exclusively in Roman gold coins

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Xuanzang noted that Nalanda's gatekeeper tested candidates on advanced logic and philosophy at the outer gate, and only 2 or 3 out of 10 passed the rigorous preliminary viva to gain admittance.

Q13. The transition from the Early Historic to the Early Medieval period in Indian historiography (c. 300–1000 CE) has been interpreted by historians like R.S. Sharma as:

- ☐ A A period of extreme economic centralization with total elimination of private property ☐ B The emergence of 'Indian Feudalism' characterized by political fragmentation, proliferation of land grants, subinfeudation, agrarian expansion, and ruralization of economy ☐ C The immediate industrialization of urban centers with steam machinery ☐ D A sudden return to nomadic hunting and gathering across the subcontinent

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Indian Feudalism thesis argues that royal land grants created a hierarchy of landed intermediaries (Samantas), leading to political decentralization and serf-like agrarian dependence.

Q14. In the Chola revenue system, what were the primary classifications of taxes denoted by 'Kadamai' and 'Kudimai'?

- ☐ A Kadamai was land revenue tax paid to the state or temple, whereas Kudimai represented manual labour dues or personal services rendered by tenants ☐ B Kadamai was maritime import duty on horses, Kudimai was diamond mining tax ☐ C Kadamai was gold toll on temple bells, Kudimai was marriage tax ☐ D Both were identical cash fines imposed on criminal theft

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: In Chola epigraphy, Kadamai was the basic land rent/assessment paid by landholders, while Kudimai represented customary obligations of public labour and service owed by agrarian tenants.

Q15. Which prominent Buddhist council was patronized by Kushana Emperor Kanishka I in Kashmir, leading to the formal codification of Mahayana Buddhism and compilation of the Mahavibhasha?

- ☐ A First Buddhist Council at Rajgriha ☐ B Second Buddhist Council at Vaishali ☐ C Third Buddhist Council at Pataliputra ☐ D Fourth Buddhist Council at Kundalavana

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Fourth Buddhist Council was convened under Kanishka at Kundalavana (Kashmir), presided over by Vasumitra and Ashvaghosha, consolidating Mahayana doctrine and Sanskrit canons.

Q16. What distinguishes the Gandhara school of art from the Mathura school of art in ancient sculpture during the Kushana era?

- ☐ A Gandhara used indigenous spotted red sandstone with indigenous themes, Mathura used Italian marble exclusively ☐ B Gandhara combined Greco-Roman stylistic realism (wavy hair, drapery folds, muscular realism) using grey schist, while Mathura evolved indigenous Indian iconography using spotted red sandstone ☐ C Gandhara produced only wooden masks, while Mathura made bronze cannons ☐ D Both schools produced only abstract geometric cubes without figurative representations

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Gandhara art was Greco-Buddhist (Hellenistic drapery and features in blue-grey schist/stucco), while the Mathura school was deeply indigenous, spiritual, and sculpted from spotted red sandstone.

Q17. In the administration of ancient South Indian villages, what was the structural difference between an 'Ur' and a 'Sabha' (or Mahasabha)?

- ☐ A The Ur was the assembly of non-Brahmadeya tax-paying peasant villages, while the Sabha was the exclusive assembly of scholarly Brahmanas in Brahmadeya settlements ☐ B The Ur was a military outpost of elephant trainers, while the Sabha was a court of foreign envoys ☐ C The Ur met only during full eclipses, while the Sabha met daily in the royal palace ☐ D There was zero difference; both were identical modern municipal corporations

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: In Chola rural governance, the Ur was the assembly of ordinary agrarian peasants (Vellanvagai villages), whereas the Sabha/Mahasabha was the specialized gathering in Brahmana tax-free gift villages (Brahmadeya).

Q18. Which major rock edict of Emperor Ashoka contains his poignant expression of remorse and profound transformation from 'Digvijaya' (military conquest) to 'Dhammavijaya' (conquest through righteousness) following the Kalinga War?

- ☐ A Major Rock Edict I ☐ B Major Rock Edict V ☐ C Major Rock Edict XIII ☐ D Minor Rock Edict I

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Major Rock Edict XIII describes the tragic devastation of the Kalinga War (100,000 killed, 150,000 carried away captive) and proclaims Ashoka's renunciation of warfare in favour of Dhammavijaya.

Q19. What was the significance of the Aihole Inscription of 634 CE composed by the court poet Ravikirti?

- ☐ A It commemorates the decisive victory of Chalukya King Pulakeshin II over Harshavardhana on the banks of the Narmada river ☐ B It records the defeat of Alexander the Great by Chandragupta Maurya ☐ C It details the invasion of South India by the Mauryan general Bindusara ☐ D It contains the complete astronomical tables of Aryabhata

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Ravikirti's poetic Prashasti at the Meguti temple in Aihole praises Pulakeshin II of Badami and records his military triumph halting northern emperor Harsha's expansion at the Narmada.

Q20. The concept of 'Samanta', which originally meant an adjoining neighbour or boundary ruler, evolved in Indian polity by the 6th century CE into:

- ☐ A A subordinate feudatory chief or military vassal obligated to pay tribute, provide troops, and attend the imperial overlord's court ☐ B A foreign ambassador from the Roman empire ☐ C A humble tax collector who owned no property ☐ D A judicial prosecutor specializing in maritime piracy

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The term Samanta shifted semantically from 'neighbouring king' to 'subordinate feudatory/tributary vassal' within the emerging medieval hierarchy of political subordination.

Q21. What was the primary function of the 'Nagaram' in the urban political economy of ancient South India?

- ☐ A An autonomous corporate assembly of merchants and traders managing commerce, market regulations, and taxes in mercantile centres ☐ B A military garrison housing war horses ☐ C A monastery housing ascetic hermits only ☐ D A port tribunal that prohibited overseas trade

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Nagaram was the organized corporate body and commercial assembly of traders and merchants (like the Manigramam and Ayyavole 500) governing market towns.

Q22. The Arthashastra prescribes that an ideal king must follow which principle regarding royal duty and public governance?

- ☐ A 'Prajasukhe sukham rajnah, prajanam cha hite hitam' (In the happiness of his subjects lies his happiness; in their welfare, his welfare) ☐ B 'The king answers only to foreign bankers and owes nothing to common peasants' ☐ C 'The ruler must confiscate all private wealth every winter solstice' ☐ D 'Might is right and justice is whatever benefits the king's private pleasures'

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Kautilya asserts: 'In the happiness of the subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare his welfare. The king shall not consider as good only that which pleases him, but what pleases the subjects.'

Q23. In ancient Indian numismatics, what is the defining characteristic of 'Punch-Marked Coins' (Ahad-mudra) from the Mahajanapada and Mauryan eras?

- ☐ A They were cast in circular steel dies bearing Greek alphabetical inscriptions and king portraits ☐ B They were irregular silver or copper pieces stamped with individual punch symbols (sun, tree, hill, elephant) without any written royal names or dates ☐ C They were round paper banknotes stamped by imperial seals ☐ D They were porcelain tokens imported from Imperial China

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Punch-marked coins (Karshapanas/Puranas) were pieces of silver/copper alloy cut to a standard weight and impressed with multiple independent symbolic punches (sun, six-armed symbol, arched hill), lacking legends.

Q24. Which famous traveler from Tang Dynasty China visited Harsha's empire and described the grand quinquennial assembly of religious tolerance and state philanthropy held at Prayaga?

- ☐ A Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang) ☐ B Fa Xian (Faxian) ☐ C I-Tsing (Yijing) ☐ D Marco Polo

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Xuanzang witnessed Harsha's grand assembly at the confluence of the Ganga and Yamuna at Prayaga (Maha Moksha Parishad), where Harsha gave away accumulated imperial treasures to scholars, ascetics, and the needy.

Q25. In the Pallava and Chola architectural traditions, what structural milestone marked the transition from rock-cut architecture to structural stone temples?

- ☐ A The Shore Temple at Mamallapuram and the Kailasanatha Temple at Kanchipuram built under Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha) ☐ B The Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro ☐ C The Ashokan pillars at Sarnath and Lauriya Nandangarh ☐ D The Iron Pillar of Delhi erected by Chandragupta II

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Under Pallava king Rajasimha (Narasimhavarman II), Dravidian temple architecture shifted from rock-cut cave rathas to free-standing structural masonry stone temples like the Shore Temple and Kanchi Kailasanatha.

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET G)

01 A B C D	02 A B C D	03 A B C D	04 A B C D	05 A B C D
06 A B C D	07 A B C D	08 A B C D	09 A B C D	10 A B C D
11 A B C D	12 A B C D	13 A B C D	14 A B C D	15 A B C D
16 A B C D	17 A B C D	18 A B C D	19 A B C D	20 A B C D
21 A B C D	22 A B C D	23 A B C D	24 A B C D	25 A B C D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & IN-DEPTH SCHOLARLY EXPLANATIONS (SET G)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis
1	A	Kautilya's Saptanga theory models the state as an organic body with seven essential elements: Swami (head/king), Amatya (eyes/ministers), Janapada (legs/territory), Durga (arms/fort), Kosha (mouth/treasury), Danda (brain/army), and Mitra (ears/allies).
2	B	The Kudavolai system was an ancient Chola democratic lottery where palm-leaf ballots of qualified candidates were shuffled in an earthen pot (kuda) and drawn by a child before the assembly.
3	A	The inscriptions strictly disqualified anyone who had not submitted financial accounts of past committee service, anyone convicted of major sins (Patakas), or their close agnatic relatives.
4	A	The Gupta administrative system divided the empire into Bhuktis (provinces governed by Uparikas), further subdivided into Vishayas (districts headed by Vishayapatis), Vithis, and Gramas.
5	B	Agrahara grants transferred royal revenue collection rights, administrative immunity from royal officers (Apravesyam), and judicial authority over the village to Brahmana scholars or temples in perpetuity.
6	A	Muventar ('the three crowned kings') refers to the Chera, Chola, and Pandya dynasties who held sway over the ancient Tamil country during the Sangam era.
7	A	Excavations at Arikamedu (Puducherry) and Pattanam (ancient Muziris) yielded Roman Mediterranean amphorae, rouletted ware, Roman glass, and vast hoards of Imperial Roman gold coins (denarii).
8	A	In his 5th Major Rock Edict, Ashoka created the special cadre of Dhamma Mahamattas (Ministers of Dhamma) to propagate moral precepts, dispense welfare, and supervise sectarian harmony.
9	B	Megasthenes recorded that Pataliputra was governed by a 30-member municipal commission divided into 6 boards of 5 members each: arts/crafts, foreigners, births/deaths, trade, manufacturing, and sales taxes.
10	B	Shrenis exercised corporate self-governance, laid down trade codes (Shreni-dharma recognized by kings), operated apprentice systems, issued seal-tokens, and accepted permanent cash deposits (Akshayanivi).
11	A	Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription (the earliest long, chaste Sanskrit inscription) details how he repaired the breached embankment of Sudarshana Lake out of his own treasury without emergency levies (Vishti or Pranaya).
12	B	Xuanzang noted that Nalanda's gatekeeper tested candidates on advanced logic and philosophy at the outer gate, and only 2 or 3 out of 10 passed the rigorous preliminary viva to gain admittance.
13	B	The Indian Feudalism thesis argues that royal land grants created a hierarchy of landed intermediaries (Samantas), leading to political decentralization and serf-like agrarian dependence.
14	A	In Chola epigraphy, Kadamai was the basic land rent/assessment paid by landholders, while Kudimai represented customary obligations of public labour and service owed by agrarian tenants.
15	D	The Fourth Buddhist Council was convened under Kanishka at Kundalavana (Kashmir), presided over by Vasumitra and Ashvaghosha, consolidating Mahayana doctrine and Sanskrit canons.
16	B	Gandhara art was Greco-Buddhist (Hellenistic drapery and features in blue-grey schist/stucco), while the Mathura school was deeply indigenous, spiritual, and sculpted from spotted red sandstone.
17	A	In Chola rural governance, the Ur was the assembly of ordinary agrarian peasants (Vellanvagai villages), whereas the Sabha/Mahasabha was the specialized gathering in Brahmana tax-free gift villages (Brahmadeya).
18	C	Major Rock Edict XIII describes the tragic devastation of the Kalinga War (100,000 killed, 150,000 carried away captive) and proclaims Ashoka's renunciation of warfare in favour of Dhammavijaya.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis
19	A	Ravikirti's poetic Prashasti at the Meguti temple in Aihole praises Pulakeshin II of Badami and records his military triumph halting northern emperor Harsha's expansion at the Narmada.
20	A	The term Samanta shifted semantically from 'neighbouring king' to 'subordinate feudatory/tributary vassal' within the emerging medieval hierarchy of political subordination.
21	A	Nagaram was the organized corporate body and commercial assembly of traders and merchants (like the Manigramam and Ayyavole 500) governing market towns.
22	A	Kautilya asserts: 'In the happiness of the subjects lies the king's happiness; in their welfare his welfare. The king shall not consider as good only that which pleases him, but what pleases the subjects.'
23	B	Punch-marked coins (Karshapanas/Puranas) were pieces of silver/copper alloy cut to a standard weight and impressed with multiple independent symbolic punches (sun, six-armed symbol, arched hill), lacking legends.
24	A	Xuanzang witnessed Harsha's grand assembly at the confluence of the Ganga and Yamuna at Prayaga (Maha Moksha Parishad), where Harsha gave away accumulated imperial treasures to scholars, ascetics, and the needy.
25	A	Under Pallava king Rajasimha (Narasimhavarman II), Dravidian temple architecture shifted from rock-cut cave rathas to free-standing structural masonry stone temples like the Shore Temple and Kanchi Kailasanatha.